GIACOMO MELLI

giacomo.melli@sociology.ox.ac.uk ◇ Personal Website · Google Scholar · ORCID

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Social Inequalities, Social Stratification, Comparative Political Sociology, Life Course, Quantitative Methods, Social Network Analysis

EDUCATION

Doctor of Philosophy (PhD) in Sociology 2023 - 2026
University of Oxford (UK)
Courses: Core Econometrics, Advanced Econometrics, Machine Learning, Longitudinal Data Analysis
Supervisors: Geoffrey Evans, Nan Dirk de Graaf
Thesis title: 'The Bond That Lasts? Class Mobility, Political Socialisation, and Electoral Participation in Britain.'
DPhil Awarded: 14 September 2026
Examiners: Daniel Oesch (Lausanne), Stephen Fisher (Oxford)

MSc in Sociology and Social Research, *summa cum laude* 2020 - 2023
University of Trento (IT)
Courses: Advanced Social Networks, Panel Data Analysis, Survey Design for Social Research, Quantitative Methods, Statistics for Opinion Research, Research Methods in Political Science, Social Stratification and Mobility
Thesis title: 'Where I Stand and What I Stand For. Subjective Social Position and Political Attitudes in Europe.'
Supervisors: Stefani Scherer, Geoffrey Evans, Leo Azzollini

- **Nuffield College** - University of Oxford Autumn 2022
  Junior Visiting Scholar to the Sociology Group; Advisor: Geoffrey Evans

BA in Political, Social, and International Science, *summa cum laude* 2017 - 2020
University of Bologna (IT)

METHODS TRAINING

- **Mitchell Autumn School in Social Network Analysis** Oct – Dec 2026
  Mitchell Centre for Social Network Analysis, University of Manchester, one of Europe's leading centres for network research. Semester-long course (10 weeks of seminars and weekly practical exercises, followed by individual consultation on own network project). Network concepts and theory, whole-network and ego-network analysis, network data collection, visualisation, and analysis in UCINET. Taught by the Centre's eight academic members: Martin Everett, Filip Agneessens, Nick Crossley, Elisa Bellotti, Philip Leifeld, Nikita Basov, Tomáš Diviák, and Michael Genkin. Certificate of completion (in progress).
- **Advanced Social Networks** 2022
  MSc in Sociology and Social Research, University of Trento (6 ECTS)
- Core Econometrics and Advanced Econometrics 2025
  Department of Economics, University of Oxford. Audited, MPhil in Economics. Instructor: Bent Nielsen
- Machine Learning 2024
  Oxford Internet Institute, University of Oxford. Audited, MSc in Social Data Science. Instructor: Chris Russell
- Machine Learning for Social Science 2024
  RECSM Summer Methods School, Universitat Pompeu Fabra, Barcelona. Instructor: Christoph Kern
- TN Square - Trento School of Applied Quantitative Methods 2024
  Department of Sociology and Social Research, University of Trento
- Comparative Social Research with Multi-Group Structural Equation Modelling 2023
  GESIS Spring Seminar, Cologne

PUBLICATIONS AND PREPRINTS

Melli, Giacomo. Given and Chosen Ties: Status, Personal Networks, and Political Behaviour in Britain. Preprint.

Melli, Giacomo, Leo Azzollini, & Stefani Scherer. *Drawing the Line: Status by Association across 28 Societies*. Preprint.

Melli, Giacomo. The Reproduction of Political Inequality: Parents Account for Class Differences in Turnout. *Under review.*

Melli, Giacomo. How Parties Reshaped Class Participation: The Central Role of Parental Abstention. *Under review.*

Melli, Giacomo, Leo Azzollini, & Franco Bonomi Bezzo (2026) Healthcare Provision and Attitudes Towards Redistribution. A Regional Analysis across Europe. *Journal of European Public Policy*, *33*(4), 1119–1147.

Dolci, Giorgio & **Melli, Giacomo** (2026) Measuring Populism in Europe. Comparison and Validation in the European Social Survey. *Quality & Quantity*, *60*, 837-855. (Authors contributed equally.)

Melli, Giacomo, Nan Dirk de Graaf, & Geoffrey Evans (2025) Social Mobility, Self Selection, and the Persistence of Class Inequality in Electoral Participation. *The British Journal of Sociology*, *76*(5), 1040-1051.

Melli, Giacomo & Leo Azzollini (2025) Where I Stand and What I Stand For: Subjective Status, Class, and Redistribution. *Social Science Research*, *130*, 103210. (Featured in *The Conversation*).

Melli, Giacomo (2025) Class, Subjective Status, and Turnout in Europe. *Research in Social Stratification and Mobility*, *97*, 101039.

Melli, Giacomo (2025) Intergenerational Social Class Mobility and Support for Redistributive Policies in Italy, 2003-2024. *Stato & Mercato*, *45*(3), 303-344. *Preprint available here.*

Melli, Giacomo & Leo Azzollini (2025) Uncovering Misperceptions of Social Inequalities: What Matters Most, Objective Class or Subjective Social Status? *Frontiers in Sociology*, 10:1617413.

Melli, Giacomo & Stefani Scherer (2024) Populist Attitudes, Subjective Social Status, and Resentment in Italy. *Social Indicators Research*, *173*(3), 589-606.

Book Chapters

- **Melli, Giacomo** & Stefani Scherer (2026) Identità di classe e attitudini verso le disuguaglianze e la redistribuzione [Class Identity and Attitudes towards Inequality and Redistribution]. In C. Ranci, A. Parma, & M. Matsaganis (eds.) *Insicurezza economica. Anatomia del caso italiano*. Bologna: il Mulino.
- van Ditmars, Mathilde M., Macarena Ares, & **Giacomo Melli**. *Social Class and Voting*. In P. Vasilopoulos, A. Sanders, & R. Dassonneville (eds.) *Voting Behaviour*. Oxford University Press, under contract, expected 2027

Working Papers

- **Melli, Giacomo**. *Political Inequality in Democratic Engagement. Can Public Spending on Education Close the Gap?*
- **Melli, Giacomo**. *Who Misreports Social Origins? Measurement Bias in Retrospective Class and Education Data*
- **Melli, Giacomo**, Leo Azzollini (Trento), Stefani Scherer (Trento), & Geoffrey Evans (Oxford). *Broken Promises of Mobility? A Counterfactual Decomposition of Structural Change and Political Disengagement*
- **Melli, Giacomo**, Mathilde M. van Ditmars (Milan), & Geoffrey Evans (Oxford). *The Political Relevance of Subjective Class in Europe (1987-2019)*
- **Melli, Giacomo** & Fabian Kratz (LMU Munich). *The Rising Importance of Social Origin: A Comparative Analysis of Political Dissatisfaction*

- Azzollini, Leo (Trento), **Melli, Giacomo**, & Clara Weißenfels (Siegen). *Life Course Resource Trajectory Model for Political Engagement*
- **Melli, Giacomo**, Franco Bonomi Bezzo (Milan), & Anne-Marie Jeannet (Milan). *The Value of Work Across Generations and Gender: How Grandparents Matter in Post-Industrial Societies*
- **Melli, Giacomo** & Enrico Benassi (Oxford). *Housing Trajectories and the Lasting Echo of Social Origin on Political Engagement*
- van Ditmars, Mathilde M. (Milan) & **Melli, Giacomo**. *The Intergenerational Continuity of the Educational Divide in Young Europeans' Political Attitudes and EU Support*

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Political Sociology (undergraduate level) 2024 - 2026
University of Oxford *Oxford, UK*
Small-group tutorial teaching; weekly essays and written examinations marked, with written and oral feedback.

Sociological Theory (undergraduate level) 2025
University of Oxford *Oxford, UK*
Small-group tutorial teaching; weekly essays marked, with written and oral feedback.

Quantitative Methods (undergraduate level) Oct 2021 – Mar 2022
University of Trento *Trento, IT*
Teaching assistant on two BA courses. Individual and small-group revision sessions.

FUNDING AND AWARDS

Sir Roger Fry Scholarship Oct 2023 – Sep 2026
Awarded by Trinity College (Oxford) in conjunction with the Department of Sociology of the University of Oxford.

Department of Sociology Graduate Research Support Funding 2024, 2025
Awarded by the Department of Sociology (Oxford) to support conference attendance and training courses.

Graduate Scholarship 2025
Awarded by the Governing Body of Trinity College (Oxford) for outstanding academic achievements.

RC28 Aage B. Sørensen Travel Award 2025
In recognition of good scholarship in the field of stratification by the Research Committee on Social Stratification and Mobility of ISA to attend the 2025 Spring Meeting in Milan.

Graduate Prize 2024
Awarded by the Governing Body of Trinity College (Oxford) for excellent academic achievements.

INVITED TALKS

Department of Sociology and Social Research, University of Trento 2025
Brown Bag Seminar Series of the Center for Social Inequality Studies
'Political Socialisation and Electoral Participation over the Life Course. Class, Family, and the Reproduction of Inequality.'

Department of Social and Political Science, University of Milan 2025
Parties, Voters, and Elections Seminar Series
'Class, Family, and Turnout. The Intergenerational Transmission of Electoral Participation over the Life Course'

European Studies Centre, St Antony's College, University of Oxford 2024
Left-behind Places across Europe: Emergence, Characteristics, Perspectives

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant Apr 2023 – Sep 2023
Department of Sociology and Social Research, University of Trento *Trento, IT*
PRIN project 'RISing – RISing Inequality and Social Insecurity of the middle class: measures, drivers, policies'; Advisor: Stefani Scherer.

Internship Sep 2021 – Oct 2021
Department of Social and Political Sciences, University of Milan *Milan, IT*
ERC project 'DESPO - Deindustrializing Societies and the Political Consequences'; Advisor: Anne-Marie Jeannet

ACADEMIC SERVICE AND ORGANISATION

Conference and Session Organisation

- Stream organiser, 'Economic Sociology and Democracy', SISEC, Florence (2 sessions, 10 papers), with Leo Azzollini (Trento) 2026
- Stream organiser, 'Life Course and the Politics of Social Policy', ESPAnet, Milan (2 sessions, 10 papers), with Anne-Marie Jeannet (Milan) and Leo Azzollini (Trento) 2025
- Session chair, ECSR (Cologne) and RC28 Spring Meeting (Milan) 2025

Peer Review
Reviewer for *British Journal of Sociology*, *British Journal of Political Science*, *Acta Politica*, *Research in Social Stratification and Mobility*, *European Societies*, *Advances in Life Course Research*, *International Journal of Comparative Sociology*, *International Journal of Public Opinion Research*, *Quality & Quantity*, *Socius*.

Representation
Postgraduate Representative at the Department of Sociology of the University of Oxford Nov 2023 - Oct 2024

CONFERENCES

- Convegno della Società Italiana di Scienza Politica (SISP), Trento 2026
- Politics & Society Workshop Series, Queen Mary University of London 2026
- SISEC, Italian Society of Economic Sociology 2023, 2025, 2026
- In_Equality Conference, Konstanz 2026
- ECSR - European Consortium for Sociological Research, Cologne 2025
- ESPAnet, Milan 2025
- RC28 - ISA Committee on Social Stratification and Mobility, Milan 2025
- World Values Survey Conference, King's College London 2024
- Inaugural British Journal of Sociology Conference, LSE 2024
- International Conference on Political Sociology (AIS), University of Bologna 2024
- Elections, Public Opinion and Parties (EPOP), Manchester 2024
- Politics & Society Workshop Series, University of Oslo 2024

SKILLS

Language Skills Italian (native), English (C2 – full professional proficiency), Spanish (C1 – advanced)
IT Skills Stata (advanced), R (intermediate), LaTeX (intermediate), Python (working knowledge), UCINET (basic)

REFERENCES

Geoffrey Evans
Nuffield College
University of Oxford
New Road, Oxford
OX1 1NF, UK
geoffrey.evans@
nuffield.ox.ac.uk

Nan Dirk de Graaf
Nuffield College
University of Oxford
New Road, Oxford
OX1 1NF, UK
nan.degraaf@
nuffield.ox.ac.uk

Stefani Scherer
Department of Sociology
University of Trento
Via Verdi 26, 38122
Trento, Italy
stefani.scherer@
unitn.it

Delia Baldassarri
Department of Sociology
New York University
79 Washington Square East
New York, NY 10003
db1794@nyu.edu